

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6 4 2
 ♥ 5
 ♦ J 5 3
 ♣ A K 9 7 4

♠ K Q J 10 7 5

♥ A J 8 6 3

♦ A

♣ 5



♠ 3
 ♥ 10 4
 ♦ K Q 10 9 6 2
 ♣ 10 8 6 2

♠ A 8

♥ K Q 9 7 2

♦ 8 7 4

♣ Q J 3

Since there has not been a clear agreement on the trump suit you can assume it is ♥s, the last bid suit.

So you have two Key-Cards (♠A and ♥K, along with the ♥Q). You therefore bid 5♠ and partner bids 6♥.

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♠
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8
 ♥ 10 7 4
 ♦ A K J 9
 ♣ 9 8 6 5 2

♠ K Q J 5

♥ A Q J 3

♦ Q 6

♣ K Q J



♠ 6 4

♥ 8 6 2

♦ 10 7 4 3 2

♣ 10 4 3

♠ A 10 9 7 3 2

♥ K 9 5

♦ 8 5

♣ A 7

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	5 ♣
Pass	5 ♥	Pass	5 ♠
All Pass			
5 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ K			

Partner's jump to 4 ♠ indicates he is prepared to play at game even if you have as few as 6 points. So he must have 20 points or so. With your 14 that puts you in slam range.

Despite your conviction that this hand is going to slam you should **NOT** ask for Key-Cards holding a worthless doubleton. Instead, you make a slam try by bidding your cheapest control, 5 ♣. Partner says 5 ♥. What is your next bid?

You can only say 5 ♠. Partner would have control-bid ♦ s if he held the Ace since controls are bid up-the-line. His failure to show it means he doesn't have it. Since you might be off the first two ♦ tricks you stop at 5 ♠.

Yes, partner should probably have opened 2NT. Sometimes partners don't make the bids you think they oughta.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ 10 3 2
♦ Q 9 7 4
♣ J 9 6 5

♠ J 10 8 7

♥ A 7

♦ A K 6 3

♣ A 8 2



♠ A 4

♥ Q J 9 4

♦ J 10 8 2

♣ 10 7 4

♠ K Q 9 6 2

♥ K 8 6 5

♦ 5

♣ K Q 3

You have 3 Key-Cards so you bid 5♦. Partner bids
6♠.

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

Pass

1♠

Pass

3♠

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♦

Pass

6♠

All Pass

6♠ by South

Lead: ♥2

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 6
 ♥ 7 4 3
 ♦ 10 9 8 7 4
 ♣ 7 5 4

♠ K Q 8 4

♥ A J 6

♦ J 3

♣ Q J 8 3



♠ 5 3
 ♥ 10 9 8 2
 ♦ A Q 6 2
 ♣ 10 9 2

♠ A J 9 7 2

♥ K Q 5

♦ K 5

♣ A K 6

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♠	Pass	6♠

All Pass

6♠ by South

Lead: ♣4

Your partnership plays Jacoby 2NT convention, so partner's 2NT shows a game-forcing raise in ♠s. Your 3NT bid indicates a 5-card suit and "extra values". Partner's 4♥ is a control-bid showing the ♥A.

What you need to know now about partner's hand is Key-Cards so you bid 4NT. He answers 5♠. What is your bid?

Partner's response says 2 Key-Cards and the ♠Q. So you are missing either the trump King or the ♦A. So you shouldn't bid 7, but you will almost surely make 6. You bid 6♠.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 6 2
 ♥ K J 8 5 3 2
 ♦ 9 4
 ♣ 8 2

♠ A Q

♥ 10 7 4

♦ K J 6 3

♣ K Q J 7



♠ 10 9 5 4 3

♥ A Q 9

♦ 2

♣ 9 5 4 3

♠ K J 7

♥ 6

♦ A Q 10 8 7 5

♣ A 10 6

Partner's 3♦ bid shows a very good hand with probable slam interest. It is very tempting to say 3NT now but you don't have ♥s stopped and don't know if partner does. So with good ♦ support you bid 4♦. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠A and ♦K. But you don't have the ♦Q so you answer 5♥. Partner bids 6♦.

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♦
All Pass			
6♦ by South			
Lead: ♣8			

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 4

♥ 10 3

♦ A Q 10 7

♣ 10 6 5

♠ A 6 5 2

♥ Q J 5 2

♦ K J 3

♣ 8 2



♠ J 3

♥ 7

♦ 9 8 6 5 4 2

♣ J 9 4 3

♠ K 10 8

♥ A K 9 8 6 4

♦ —

♣ A K Q 7

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by South			
Lead: ♠7			

Your partner's 3♥ is a limit-raise, 11-12 points with ♥ support.

What you want to know is whether partner holds the ♠A. If you bid 4NT and he shows two Key-Cards all will be well, you will know they are the two missing Aces. But if he shows just 1 Key-Card you will be in the soup since you can't tell if that Key-Card is the useful ♠A or the practically useless ♦A. So you don't use RKCB, you use control-showing and bid 4♣. Partner says 4♥.

Partner would have control-bid ♦s if he had the Ace. You may not think that helps but it does since now you can bid RKCB. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♣. What is your next bid?

It was a lot of work but you have figured out that partner holds 11-12 points including one Key-Card which must be the ♠A. It looks like the slam is a good idea so you say 6♥.

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 3
 ♥ Q 9 2
 ♦ K Q 8 7 5
 ♣ 10 7 2

♠ K 8 6 5 2

♥ K J 10 7

♦ —

♣ A 9 8 3



♠ J

♥ A 6 5 4 3

♦ J 10 9 4

♣ 6 5 4

♠ A Q 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ K Q J

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			
Lead: ♦K			

Board 8

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 3 2
 ♥ J 3 2
 ♦ 8 7 6 4 3
 ♣ 8 4 3

♠ A 10 8

♥ K 9 8 4

♦ K 9

♣ K 10 6 5



♠ 9 7 6 5 4

♥ Q 5

♦ 10 5 2

♣ A 7 2

♠ K Q J

♥ A 10 7 6

♦ A Q J

♣ Q J 9

West	North	East	South
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Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
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Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
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All Pass

5♥ by South

Lead: ♠ 3

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.

Board 9

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3 2
♥ 4 3
♦ J 9 6 2
♣ A 7 6 4

♠ A K Q J
♥ A J 10 7
♦ A 5
♣ K Q 10



♠ 10 9 8 6 4
♥ 6 2
♦ 10 8 3
♣ J 5 2

♠ 7
♥ K Q 9 8 5
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ 9 8 3

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, so you bid 5♣. Partner bids the ♥ slam.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			
Lead: ♣A			

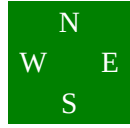
Board 10

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 4
 ♥ J 7 2
 ♦ J 10 5 2
 ♣ A 10 9 3

♠ K 10
 ♥ A K 9 8 4
 ♦ K Q 8
 ♣ K Q 6



♠ 9 8 2
 ♥ Q 10 3
 ♦ 9 7 6
 ♣ J 7 5 4

♠ A Q J 7 5 3
 ♥ 6 5
 ♦ A 4 3
 ♣ 8 2

The bidding has been as shown.

Your partner has shown a minimum opening hand, but with 6 ♠s. You are happy with the 8-card trump fit but need to know about Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner answers 5 ♠ and it is your bid again.

Partner has two Aces and the ♠Q. That should be all he needs to make slam so you bid 6 ♠.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♠
Pass	6 ♠		
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ J			

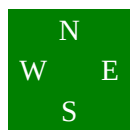
Board 11

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3
 ♥ 6
 ♦ 10 9 6 5
 ♣ A 9 8 6 3 2

♠ A K Q J
 ♥ A Q 10 4 3
 ♦ A J 8
 ♣ 7



♠ 10 9 8
 ♥ 7 2
 ♦ 3 2
 ♣ K Q J 10 5 4

♠ 7 6 4 2
 ♥ K J 9 8 5
 ♦ K Q 7 4
 ♣ —

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

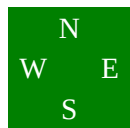
The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, but you also have a void in ♣s. You therefore answer 6♣. Partner goes all the way to 7♥.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	7♥		
All Pass			
7♥ by South			
Lead: ♣A			

Board 12
 South Deals
 N-S Vul

♠ Q J 8
 ♥ 5 3 2
 ♦ A 9 7
 ♣ 8 6 5 2

♠ K 6 5 2
 ♥ A Q 7 4
 ♦ K 8 6
 ♣ A Q



♠ 4 3
 ♥ 9 8 6
 ♦ 5 4 2
 ♣ 10 9 7 4 3

♠ A 10 9 7
 ♥ K J 10
 ♦ Q J 10 3
 ♣ K J

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♦	Pass	5♠
All Pass			

5♠ by South
 Lead: ♣5

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has 15-17 points and 4 ♠s. You have 18 points and 4 ♠s. You plan to bid the slam, but first you check Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner says 5♣.

You are missing 1 Key-Card. Slam has become less certain. You decide to see if partner has the trump Queen so you bid 5♦. Partner bids 5♠. What do you say next?

Partner denies having the ♠Q. Knowing that the best you could hope for would be a finesse to make the slam you give up your quest and pass.

Board 13

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 4
 ♥ J 4 3
 ♦ J 8 6
 ♣ 10 9 8 2

♠ A K Q J 3

♥ 10 8 7 5

♦ K

♣ K Q J

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 6 2

♥ Q 2

♦ 10 5 3 2

♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ 9 7

♥ A K 9 6

♦ A Q 9 7 4

♣ A 5

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1♦
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♦	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			
Lead: ♠4			

Your 2♥ bid is a Reverse, showing 17+ points.

There has been no agreement on trumps, so you assume that North has implicitly agreed to ♥s. So you respond 5♣, showing 4 Key-Cards, three Aces and the ♥K. Partner next bids 5♦.

5♦ is the Queen Ask. Partner obviously is thinking about a Grand Slam and wants to know whether you hold the trump Queen (♥Q). Since you do not have the card you return to the agreed trump suit at the lowest level - which is 5♥. Partner now bids 6♥.

Board 14

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 4
 ♥ 10 4 2
 ♦ 2
 ♣ J 10 9 7 5

♠ A 6 3

♥ A K 9 8 6 5

♦ K

♣ A 3 2



♠ Q J 5 2

♥ 7

♦ 9 6 4 3

♣ Q 8 6 4

♠ K 7

♥ Q J 3

♦ A Q J 10 8 7 5

♣ K

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♣	Pass	5NT
Pass	6 ♦	Pass	7NT

All Pass

7NT by South

Lead: ♣J

The bidding has been as shown. Yes, you could have jump-shifted on your first bid.

Slam in ♥s is almost certain, but you should check for Key-Cards. You bid 4NT and partner says 5 ♣.

Partner shows 1 or 4 Key-cards. Since he jumped on the second round you figure it must be 4. So you have all the Key-Cards. Time to find out about the other Kings, so you bid 5NT. Partner replies 6 ♦.

Partner has 1 King, the only one left, the ♦K. You can count about 17 high-card tricks available so you bid 7NT.

Board 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 7 3
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ A 6 5 3 2
 ♣ 9 4

♠ —

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ K Q J 7 4

♣ J 10 8 3



♠ A J 9 5 4 2

♥ 5 2

♦ 9 8

♣ 7 5 2

♠ 10 8 6

♥ K Q J 8 3

♦ 10

♣ A K Q 6

West

North

East

South

Pass 3♠ Pass 1♥

Pass 6♥ Pass 4NT

All Pass

6♥ by South

6♥ by South

Lead: ♠K

Your 3♠ bid is a Splinter, agreeing ♥s as trump, and showing opening hand strength with a singleton or void in ♠s.

You have one Key-Card, the ♥A. You also have a ♠ void, but since bidding 6♠ would take you above the 6♥ level you just respond 6♥. Partner will deduce that your void is in ♠s, particularly because you Splintered in that suit. Partner passes your 6♥ bid.

Board 16

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 2
 ♥ 9 5 3 2
 ♦ A Q J 10 4
 ♣ Q 9 8

♠ A 10 8 4 3

♥ Q 10 8 4

♦ —

♣ K J 10 2



♠ 7

♥ J 7 6

♦ K 9 6 3 2

♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ K Q J 9 6 5

♥ A K

♦ 8 7 5

♣ A 5

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	6 ♦	Pass	7 ♠
All Pass			
7 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ 3			

Partner's 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least 4-card ♠ support, and a singleton or void in ♦s.

Normally you would not ask for Key-Cards with this ♦ holding. But since you know partner has at most a singleton, and that it is not the singleton ♦ A, you are safe to do so. You say 4NT, partner replies 6♦. What next?

WOW! Partner has one Key-Card and a ♦ void. So the Key-Card is the ♠ A. You don't know what the rest of partner's hand is, but he can surely take care of that small ♣. You bid 7♠.

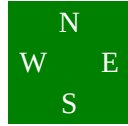
Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 4 3
 ♥ K Q 8 7 2
 ♦ J
 ♣ 9 7 6 5

♠ A Q 5
 ♥ 4
 ♦ A K 10 8 6 3
 ♣ A K Q



♠ J 9 6 2
 ♥ J 9 5 3
 ♦ 5 2
 ♣ 4 3 2

♠ K 8 7
 ♥ A 10 6
 ♦ Q 9 7 4
 ♣ J 10 8

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♥	Pass	5♠
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by South			
Lead: ♥K			

Your 2NT response shows 8+ points, with no 5-card biddable suit.

You support the ♦s and partner bids 4NT. What is your next bid?

With ♦s as trump you have 1 Key-Card, the ♥A. You answer 5♣ and partner bids 5♥. What is your bid?

This is the Queen Ask, wanting to know if you hold the ♦Q. Since you do have it you should bid a suit in which you hold a King. So you bid 5♠. That spurred partner on - he was fishing for 7♦ but when you told him you had the ♦Q, ♥A and ♠K he was able to bid 7NT.

Board 18

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 7 4 3

♥ 4

♦ 10 9 6 2

♣ 9 4 3

♠ Q 8

♥ A J 9 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A K Q 6



♠ A K J 6 5 2

♥ 5

♦ A 8 7 4

♣ 7 5

♠ —

♥ K Q 10 8 6 3 2

♦ 5 3

♣ J 10 8 2

West	North	East	South
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Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
------	----	------	----

Pass	3♥	Pass	3♠
------	----	------	----

Pass	4NT	Pass	6♥
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All Pass

6♥ by South

Lead: ♦ 10

Partner's 2♥ is a positive response, 8+ points with a 5+ card suit.

Even though it is tempting, bidding RKCB now would be a mistake because of your doubleton ♠ loser. Instead just support the ♥s. Partner cannot pass, you both know you are forced to game. In fact, partner bids 3♠.

Partner promises first round ♠ control so NOW you can bid RCKB. When you bid 4NT partner answers 6♥. This shows 1 Key-Card and a void in a suit higher than ♥s. Knowing you are missing either the ♦A or ♥K you pass.

Board 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6
 ♥ Q 4 3
 ♦ Q J 7 5 2
 ♣ Q J 8 3

♠ K 10 7 2
 ♥ A K 8 6 5
 ♦ 8 3
 ♣ 6 4



♠ 9
 ♥ J 10 9 2
 ♦ 10 9 6
 ♣ 10 9 7 5 2

♠ A Q J 8 5 4 3
 ♥ 7
 ♦ A K 4
 ♣ A K

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♦	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by South			
Lead: ♦5			

Your 2♥ response shows 8+ points, with at least 5♥s.

Your hand is looking better and better. You already gave a positive response so you know you are forced to game. It is better to keep the bidding low to allow more investigating room so you bid 3♠. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

With ♠s agreed as trumps you have two Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♥A. With no trump Queen you respond 5♥. Partner now says 5NT. What do you reply?

Partner is asking for Kings and you have just 1, the ♥K. Remember, the ♠K is not a King, it is a Key-Card which you have already counted. So you bid 6♦. Partner counts 13 tricks and bids 7NT.

Board 20

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10
 ♥ 10 7 5 3
 ♦ 9 5 3
 ♣ A Q 10 7 6

♠ Q J 7 3

♥ A 8

♦ 10 8 6 4

♣ K J 5



♠ 8 2

♥ J 9 4 2

♦ A 7

♣ 9 8 4 3 2

♠ A K 9 6 5 4

♥ K Q 6

♦ K Q J 2

♣ —

West	North	East	South
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Pass	3♠	Pass	1♠
------	----	------	----

Pass	4♥	Pass	6♠
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All Pass

6♠ by South

Lead: ♦ 3

Partner's 3♠ is a limit raise, 11-12 points and good ♠ support.

What you DO NOT say next is 4NT. If partner answered 1 Key-Card you would not know what to do. If he has a red Ace you can make slam, but if his one Key-Card were the ♣A you couldn't. Instead you make a control-showing bid of 4♣, promising first round control. Partner obliges you by bidding 4♥. What is your next bid?

Partner's bidding is like the Sherlock Holmes tale Silver Blaze, about the dog that didn't bark. Partner's ♥ bid shows that he **DOES** have the ♥A, but equally important it shows that he **DOES NOT** have the ♦A. So you know you don't have a ♥ loser but do have a ♦ loser. You bid 6♠.